

The complaint

Miss A complains that Revolut Ltd won't refund the money she lost when she was the victim of a scam.

What happened

In September 2025, Miss A was looking for some additional work and saw a job advertised online. She contacted the company and was told the job involved completing tasks to help clients promote their content on social media.

Miss A was sent links to the tasks she could complete via an instant messaging app. And she was shown how to purchase cryptocurrency and send it on to the company, in order to pay for some of the tasks she had to complete.

Miss A then made a number of payments and exchanges into cryptocurrency from her Revolut account, as set out below, in order to send funds to the job company.

Date	Details	Amount
4 September 2025	To 1 st individual	£10
4 September 2025	To 2 nd individual	£30
4 September 2025	To 2 nd individual	£10
5 September 2025	Exchange into cryptocurrency	£100
5 September 2025	Exchange into cryptocurrency	£360
5 September 2025	Exchange into cryptocurrency	£1,280
5 September 2025	Exchange into cryptocurrency	£500
8 September 2025	Exchange into cryptocurrency	£2,580
8 September 2025	Exchange into cryptocurrency	£3,000
8 September 2025	To cryptocurrency exchange	£600
8 September 2025	To cryptocurrency exchange	£800
8 September 2025	To cryptocurrency exchange	£1,378
9 September 2025	To cryptocurrency exchange	£3,080
9 September 2025	To cryptocurrency exchange	£2,880
9 September 2025	To cryptocurrency exchange	£2,000

Unfortunately, we now know the job company was a scam. The scam was uncovered after the company kept asking Miss A for increasingly large amounts before she could receive the money it said she had earned. Miss A then realised she had been the victim of a scam and reported the payments and exchanges she had made to Revolut.

Revolut investigated but didn't agree to refund the money Miss A had lost, so she referred a complaint to our service. One of our investigators looked at the complaint but didn't think anything we would have expected Revolut to have done would have prevented Miss A's loss, or that it should have to refund the payments she made. Miss A disagreed with our investigator, so the complaint has been passed to me.

What I've decided – and why

In addition to the cryptocurrency exchanges set out above, Miss A made a number of cryptocurrency withdrawals from her Revolut account as part of this scam, when the cryptocurrency was sent on to the job company. But the transfer of cryptocurrency in this way is not a regulated activity, and so I can't consider these withdrawals as part of this complaint. The exchange of funds in an account into cryptocurrency is an ancillary activity to the regulated activity of accepting a deposit of funds into an account though, so the cryptocurrency exchanges I set out above can be considered.

I've considered all the available evidence and arguments to decide what's fair and reasonable in the circumstances of this complaint.

In broad terms, the starting position in law is that a firm is expected to process payments that a customer authorises. However, where the customer made the payment as a consequence of the actions of a fraudster, it may sometimes be fair and reasonable for the bank to reimburse the customer even though they authorised the payment.

In 2024, the Payment Systems Regulator required the Faster Payments scheme operator to introduce rules to require firms to reimburse customers who had been the victims of scams in certain circumstances. But these Reimbursement Rules only apply to payments sent to an account that the victim does not control. And the exchanges into cryptocurrency Miss A made from her Revolut account, and the payments she made to a cryptocurrency exchange, involved funds moving into an account in her own name. So these payments are not covered by the Reimbursement Rules.

The first three payments Miss A made here were made to individuals, and appear to be covered by these Reimbursement Rules. So I've considered whether Revolut has fairly considered her claim under these rules.

But there are limits on what firms are expected to refund under the rules, one of which is that firms can apply an optional excess of £100 per claim. The rules say that, where a claim satisfies the criteria for reimbursement:

“The value of the Reimbursable Amount to be credited to the Victim shall be the full value of all Reimbursable FPS APP scam payments, up to the maximum level of reimbursement and less any claim excess imposed.”

And the PSR has confirmed that:

“Sending PSPs may apply an excess up to a maximum of £100 per claim.”

These first three payments Miss A made add up to a total of £50, which is less than the amount of the excess Revolut is entitled to apply. And I'm not persuaded Miss A was vulnerable in a way that materially affected her ability to protect herself from this scam, so I think it is fair for Revolut to apply the excess to her claim. And so I don't think Revolut is required to refund any money to Miss A under these Reimbursement Rules.

In addition to its responsibilities under these Reimbursement Rules, the regulatory landscape, along with good industry practice, sets out requirements for firms to protect their customers from fraud and financial harm. So, in line with this, I think Revolut should have been monitoring accounts, had systems in place to look out for unusual transactions and, in some circumstances, have carried out additional checks before processing payments.

But, even if Revolut had recognised that Miss A was at heightened risk of financial harm from fraud when making some of these payments and exchanges, I don't think the action I would have expected it to take would have prevented her loss. I'll explain why below.

Revolut has sent us evidence that it carried out a number of interventions with Miss A during these payments, and showed her a number of warnings.

These interventions included warnings that Revolut had identified the transactions Miss A was carrying out as a potential scam. Revolut explained that fraudsters will ask you to do tasks to earn a fee, but then demand money from you to release that fee. And it showed her warnings that this was likely to be a job scam, to be wary of work from home jobs, not to move funds to complete a job and to never ignore the warnings it was giving.

At one point, Revolut also spoke to Miss A over the phone. It explained it was important she was truthful with the details she provided and then asked her questions about the payments she was making. It asked if there was anyone assisting her with the payments, but Miss A answered that there wasn't and she was doing it herself. Revolut asked if the funds were being transferred to someone else's wallet once she had purchased the cryptocurrency, but Miss A answered no. And it asked if anyone was asking her to lie to her bank about the payments she was making, and Miss A answered no.

From what I've seen of her communication with the job company, Miss A told the person she was speaking to that Revolut had said this could be a scam but was then told to give Revolut incorrect information about the purpose and circumstances surrounding the payment in order to make sure it went through – which Miss A then did. Miss A also sent the person from the job company details of all the questions she was being asked by Revolut and was given answers to copy and give to Revolut in response – which Miss A then did.

So even if Revolut had asked more probing and in-depth questions about the payments and cryptocurrency exchanges Miss A was making here, I don't think she would have given it accurate or complete information about the circumstances surrounding them – as happened with the questions she was asked. And I don't think any warning I would then have expected Revolut to have provided to her would have stopped her making the payments – as the warnings she was given did not.

So I don't think anything I would reasonably have expected Revolut to have done here would have prevented Miss A making the payments or losing the money she did. And so I don't think it would be fair to require it to refund the money Miss A lost here.

I appreciate Miss A has said she feels Revolut should have intervened earlier than it did and that, if it had done, it would have made her stop sending money to the job company. But I wouldn't have expected Revolut to intervene earlier than it did here. And, while I understand she only answered Revolut's questions in the way she did because she felt the job company was legitimate and believed what she was told by the person she was speaking to, I still don't think anything I would have expected Revolut to have done here would have prevented her loss.

I recognise that Miss A has been the victim of a cruel scam and that my decision will come as a disappointment to her. She has lost a significant amount of money and I sympathise with the position she has found herself in. But I can only look at Revolut's responsibilities and, for the reasons I've set out above, I don't think it would be fair to hold it responsible for the money she lost here.

My final decision

I don't uphold this complaint.

Under the rules of the Financial Ombudsman Service, I'm required to ask Miss A to accept or reject my decision before 17 April 2026.

Alan Millward
Ombudsman